

Element K

Reflection on the Design Project

We learned that collaborating as a team and assigning tasks and roles to various members to make sure the team finished the project efficiently is absolutely essential. When doing this project the team also learned to gather different viewpoints within the team and from our stakeholders, and it has helped us go further into the project adding more details to our 3D design. Our process was very efficient concerning some members of our team, but since we are a very diverse group this process worked better for some than others. The team did a great job with taking aspects from others' designs to fulfill the desires of almost all the team members. We also did a fairly good job in distributing jobs and tasks to various team members to ensure that members in leadership roles did not become burnt out or lose motivation for the project. Not only that but our time management is also fairly well mainly concerning our overall organization of this portfolio and the design created by the team. The team would like to change the system of distributing the jobs and the overall number of jobs we had thought of. For the team though we split it into two groups nobody was assigned as a leader, rather that people slowly moved into those roles when completing the work. Another thing to change is our system of documents, though many were helpful there were a large number of them. This made it hard for teammates to navigate to them since we have to share by link, rather than inputting each name in the share section. With that teammates would only be able to see the document if they are provided the link, meaning they would not see it in their drive or email. The team learned that paying more attention to detail is essential in these types of projects, also that we as a team should have reviewed the document together rather than separately. With the method of reviewing as a group it allows changes to be made immediately rather than the designer being asked to at a later date. During the project it was surprising on the amount of time spent on planning rather than doing. Also the amount of different designs the team had come up with, and adding to that our final design was immensely different from our previous sketches. Adding to that the team had not known that the expert review would be much harsher than we expected since all the feedback we had been receiving was from adults we see everyday. For future attempts, the suggestions to our 3D prototype, made by Mr. Roberson, will likely lead to reiterations of the design, because of the many features that Mr. Roberson criticized. One of those suggestions was lowering the piping leading to the basin to reduce splash, which is an easy ask to fulfill. Another was asking basic questions to our stakeholder, which our team did by email. This should improve the results because it will allow us to deliver an exceptional prototype to our stakeholders that fulfills all their user needs. In hindsight, we realize that many designs of the hydroponic unit exist and picking a different one could make a significant difference in the results because this would change many features and aspects that were used in our final design. Another element that would change the project severely is the amount of space we were actually given by our stakeholders. If the space was smaller or bigger, many different designs would have been created, some more ambitious than the one we chose. The methods used for the step of choosing the design, were important and viable because they allowed us to evaluate all designs presented while also choosing our final one. Without this process we would be far behind on our schedule and would not have a 3D prototype to show our stakeholders. More methods we used was planning out when work would be done, so that again we would stay on schedule and have a presentable solution. In order to complete this project we have tried and used many methods that helped and faltered our process. The team has addressed any concerns and evaluated working methods to be used in future projects.